

THROWN IN BUT WALKED OUT

BLUE DENOTES POWER POINT SLIDE

**BROWN DENOTES INSTRUCTIONS TO
TECHNICIAN**

TEXT: Daniel 3:15-28

INTRO: This is such a familiar story that many times we as preachers stay away from it. It is not one of those hidden verses in the Bible that you have never heard preached on...

ILL: A lady in one church where I was pastor said to me one Sunday, “Pastor Bobo, what I like about your preaching is how you are able to get out of scripture things that aren’t even there...”

There are no hidden truths in this text... everything that can be preached on from this passage has been preached...

“The Fourth Man” - Oral Roberts

“The Smell of Smoke”

“If Not...”

“Who Is That God...”

This morning I want to use this text to talk about something that is very real to everyone in this place...

Everyone here has had circumstances in your

life where you were in a situation you did not cause but someone else did. You have had things happen to you that you did not have control over. In other words... "You were THROWN in" to that situation. What is important is not how you got into the mess you are in, but how you get out...

I am not talking to people who have caused their own problems and started their own fire and walked into it. I am talking to folks who were THROWN IN by someone else...

We are going to look at some Bible examples to help us this morning

I. JEPHTHAH

(Judges 11:1-8 NIV)

"1 ¶ Jephthah the Gileadite was a mighty warrior. His father was Gilead; his mother was a prostitute. 2 Gilead's wife also bore him sons, and when they were grown up, they drove Jephthah away. "You are not going to get any inheritance in our family," they said, "because you are the son of another woman." 3 So Jephthah fled from his brothers and settled in the land of Tob, where a group of adventurers gathered around him and followed him. 4 ¶ Some time later, when the Ammonites made war on Israel, 5 the elders of Gilead went to get Jephthah from the land of Tob. 6 "Come," they said, "be our commander, so we can fight the Ammonites." 7 Jephthah said to them, "Didn't you hate me and drive me from my father's house? Why do you come to me now, when you're in trouble?"

8 The elders of Gilead said to him, "Nevertheless, we are turning to you now; come with us to fight the Ammonites, and you will be our head over all who live in Gilead."

A. The story of Jephthah is a sad story. As with other "Judges" of the Bible, his is not a pretty picture (see Samson)...

B. Jephthah was THROWN IN to a situation he had no control over... His dad, Gilead went to a prostitute and Jephthah was the product of that union. His brothers THREW HIM OUT... "You are not going to get any inheritance in our family..."

C. The tables turn for Jephthah when he becomes a warrior and the Ammonites attack Gilead. Now the elders of Gilead... the same ones who helped THROW HIM out of town come to him and ask for his help. They even promised to make him the head over all who live in Gilead.

D. If the story ended here it would be a "Fairy Tale"... a "Happily ever after" story... but it doesn't...

E. Jephthah makes a "vow" to God. "If you give me victory, I will offer whatever comes from my house to greet me as a burnt offering..."

(Judges 11:34-35 NKJV)

"34 When Jephthah came to his house at Mizpah, there was his daughter, coming out to meet him with timbrels and dancing; and she [was his] only child. Besides her he had neither son nor daughter. 35 And it came to pass, when he saw her, that he tore his clothes, and said, "Alas, my daughter! You have brought me very low! You are among those who trouble me! For I have given my word to the LORD, and I cannot go back on it.""

F. Here is a lesson from this story that we need to learn... Those who are thrown into bad situations usually end up throwing someone else into bad situations...

The abused become abusers...

STOP THE CYCLE!!!

Now Jephthah's daughter is THROWN IN to a situation she never asked for and had no control over...

II. PAUL AND SILAS (Acts 16:22-30 NIV)

"22 The crowd joined in the attack against Paul and Silas, and the magistrates ordered them to be stripped and beaten. 23 After they had been severely flogged, they were thrown into prison, and the jailer was commanded to guard them carefully. 24 Upon receiving such orders, he put them in the

inner cell and fastened their feet in the stocks. 25 ¶
 About midnight Paul and Silas were praying and
 singing hymns to God, and the other prisoners
 were listening to them. 26 Suddenly there was such a
 violent earthquake that the foundations of the
 prison were shaken. At once all the prison doors
 flew open, and everybody's chains came loose.
 27 The jailer woke up, and when he saw the
 prison doors open, he drew his sword and was about
 to kill himself because he thought the prisoners had
 escaped. 28 But Paul shouted, "Don't harm
 yourself! We are all here!" 29 The jailer called
 for lights, rushed in and fell trembling before
 Paul and Silas. 30 He then brought them out and
 asked, "Sirs, what must I do to be saved?"

A. The scripture says that Paul and Silas
 were THROWN INTO prison...

B. This was not a situation they had "asked
 for". There is something wrong with people
 who want to be martyrs. Sure you must be
 willing to die for the sake of the Gospel, but that
 is not my calling. Paul said, "For
 me to LIVE is Christ..."

C. God had a divine plan for their being
 THROWN IN... He used it for an
 opportunity to save a whole household and everyone
 that family would touch over a lifetime...

D. When Paul and Silas came back to the
 prison after being at the jailer's home

word was sent to them to release them...

(Acts 16:35-40 NIV)

"35 ¶ When it was daylight, the magistrates sent their officers to the jailer with the order: "Release those men." 36 The jailer told Paul, "The magistrates have ordered that you and Silas be released. Now you can leave. Go in peace." 37 But Paul said to the officers: "They beat us publicly without a trial, even though we are Roman citizens, and threw us into prison. And now do they want to get rid of us quietly? No! Let them come themselves and escort us out." 38 The officers reported this to the magistrates, and when they heard that Paul and Silas were Roman citizens, they were alarmed. 39 They came to appease them and escorted them from the prison, requesting them to leave the city. 40 After Paul and Silas came out of the prison, they went to Lydia's house, where they met with the brothers and encouraged them. Then they left."

THEY WERE THROWN IN... BUT
THEY WALKED OUT!!!

III. JOSEPH

(Genesis 37:23-24 AV)

"23 ¶ And it came to pass, when Joseph was come unto his brethren, that they stript Joseph out of his coat, [his] coat of [many] colours that [was] on

*him; 24 And they took him, and cast him into a pit:
and the pit [was] empty, [there was] no water in
it.”*

A. Joseph was THROWN INTO a lot of
different situations...

- 1) Thrown into a pit
- 2) Thrown into a tempting situation
- 3) Thrown into prison

B. Joseph walked out with a ring on his
finger and a robe on his back...

CONC: I WAS THROWN IN... BUT I'M WALKING
OUT

Some of you are sitting here this morning
having been THROWN IN to some pretty rough
situations...

- 1) Some were thrown into an ungodly home
environment.
- 2) Some were thrown into an abusive
situation...
- 3) Some were thrown into tragedy and
heartache...

It is not how you were thrown in that concerns
me this morning... it is HOW ARE YOU GOING
TO WALK OUT???

Revisit the three Hebrew children..

Clothes not burned...
Hair not singed...
No smell of smoke...

THE FIRE HAD NO POWER OVER THEM...

You cannot help what you were thrown into, but
you can help how it affects the rest of your life...

YOU CAN WALK OUT!!!